

M E R N Problem – Solution Fit

shopEZ — B2C E-Commerce Marketplace (MERN Stack)

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Problem – Solution Fit

1. Introduction

This document formally validates the Problem–Solution Fit of the ShopEZ platform.

Fit is achieved when a proposed solution demonstrably and efficiently addresses the core pain points of target customer segments while delivering measurable gains that differentiate it from existing market alternatives.

2. Customer Journey !' Problem !' Solution

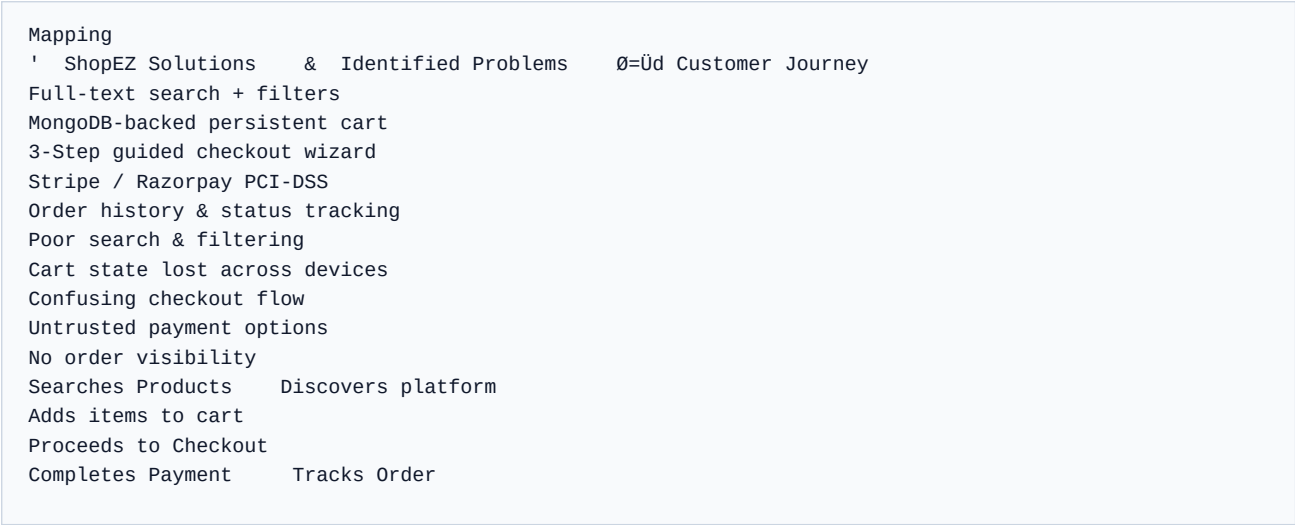


FIGURE 7.1 — CUSTOMER JOURNEY !'

PROBLEM !'

SOLUTION

MAPPING

3. Competitive Analysis

Criterion	Shopify	WooCommerce	Custom PHP	ShopEZ (MERN)
Customisability	Limited	Moderate	High	Full Control
SPA Performance	No (SSR)	No (SSR)	No	React SPA
Monthly Cost	Rs. 2,000 - Rs. 20,000	Rs. 500 - Rs. 5,000	Variable	Low (Free Tiers)
Cross-Device Cart	Yes	Yes	No	Yes (MongoDB)
Admin Dashboard	Basic	Plugin-based	Manual	Custom Analytics
Payment Gateways	Limited	Multiple (plugins)	Manual	Stripe + Razorpay
Image CDN	Yes	No	No	Cloudinary
Developer Ownership	Lock-in	Partial	Yes	Full Ownership
Scalability	Limited by plan	Limited by hosting	Complex	Stateless API

4. Fit Validation Summary

Problem	Solution Provided	Fit?
Cart state lost across sessions	MongoDB-persisted cart linked to user ID	Yes
Poor search & discovery	Full-text search + multi-criteria filter API	Yes

Problem	Solution Provided	Fit?
Confusing checkout	3-step guided wizard (Address -> Method -> Payment)	Yes
Untrusted payment process	Stripe / Razorpay PCI-DSS compliant gateway	Yes
Slow page loads	React SPA + Cloudinary CDN	Yes
No admin analytics	Custom Admin Dashboard with revenue charts	Yes
Manual image hosting	Cloudinary auto-optimize & CDN delivery	Yes

